

FMAM 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 January 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v2.0 · FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain

Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

The forecast is close to climatology in the FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain: no tercile stands out on average. Mean forecast rainfall is 212 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 213 mm (0 mm, 0%).

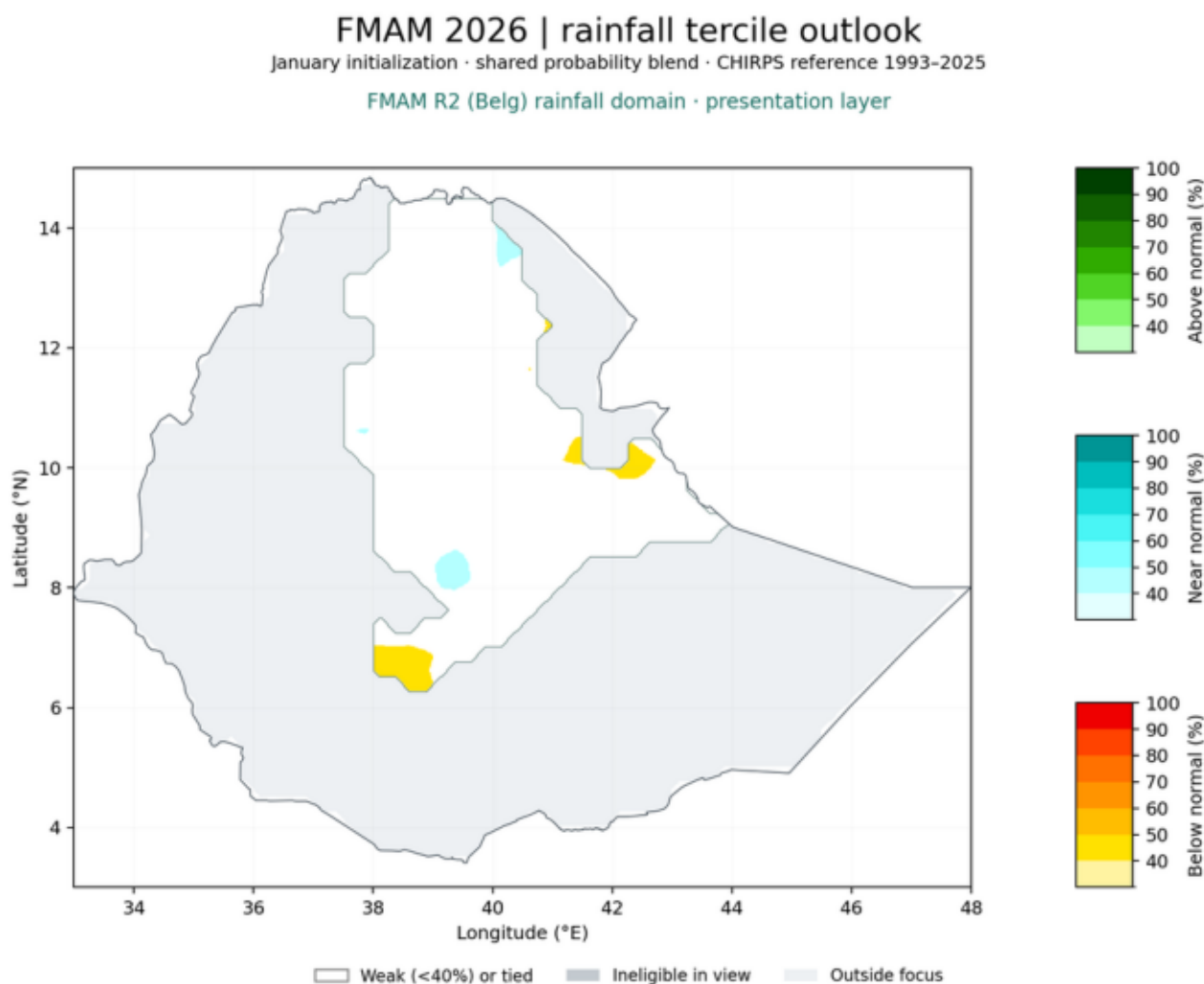


Below normal 34% Near normal 33% Above normal 33%

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: No clear tilt (close to climatology) (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain): Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero). Probability skill (RPSS) +0.057, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval +0.006 to +0.109; better than climatology in 17 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.



Display interpolation: 12x; Gaussian $\sigma=0.6$ native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a January-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — January initialization · FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
FMAM 2026	34% / 33% / 33%	100%	0 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Feb 2026 file not found (checked 9 Oct 2026)
Feb 2026	28% / 37% / 35%	95%	+2 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Feb 2026 file not found (checked 9 Oct 2026)
Mar 2026	31% / 35% / 34%	100%	+6 mm	Verification published
Apr 2026	37% / 31% / 32%	100%	−3 mm	Verification published
May 2026	37% / 33% / 30%	100%	−4 mm	Verification published

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
FMAM	+0.057 (+0.006 to +0.109)	17/24	0.093	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Feb	+0.049 (+0.014 to +0.082)	20/24	0.032	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Mar	+0.009 (−0.006 to +0.023)	17/24	0.272	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Apr	−0.013 (−0.047 to +0.014)	15/24	0.760	No demonstrated improvement over climatology
May	+0.042 (+0.003 to +0.081)	17/24	0.093	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

Target	RPSS	CRPSS	Bias	Forecast / observed anomaly	Observed below/near/above
Mar 2026	+0.032	+0.079	−38.3 mm	+6 / +44 mm	0% / 8% / 92%
Apr 2026	+0.036	+0.080	+5.7 mm	−3 / −9 mm	42% / 27% / 30%
May 2026	+0.044	+0.089	+4.4 mm	−4 / −8 mm	28% / 63% / 9%

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 January 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 8 Oct 2026 (after the target period ended, before this project downloaded its observations; SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 FMAM 1993-2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by_month listing checked 9 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: 8 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend ($\lambda = 0.43$ for FMAM) · code d932d97

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

FMAM 2026 — January initialization · FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain

